

art exhibition Visual Language

DELHI There is a ceaseless energy in painter, sculptor and architect Satish Gujral. For over five decades, he has constantly explored and reinvented his artistic sensibilities. Now, at 83, he is showcasing his latest paintings and sculptures in an exhibition called *Metamorphosis, Canvas and Bronze*, 2004-2008.

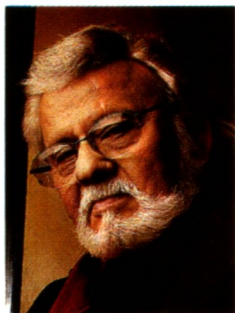
Gujral is a quick-change artist of mediums. He has worked with a host of materials such as burnt wood, bronze, ceramics and paper. "An emotion never repeats itself," he says. In the sinuous though enduring form of saddle, reins, horses, leather straps, buckles and other images, he presents a new visual language. Gujral feels that leather is the material representative of the contemporary world—as a substance, it defines the spirit of the post-Colonial globalising world.

He presents 18 new works on acrylic and canvas that capture his three-

dimensional vision, with the canvas going far beyond flat surfaces to a multitude of forms. In the *ICONS* series, he has used just three colours—black, red and gold—with tonal variations. He uses specially treated canvas and acrylic paints because the surface forms the crucial base on which he creates his art. "In each period, the artist tries to create an oeuvre that reflects his im-

mediate experience and world view, organising it into a form that embodies the spirit of changing times and the artist's response to it," says Gujral.

Also on display will be 30 sculptures in bronze which reflect his introspection of the human body in an abstract form. Not content with readymade variety, he creates his own patinas by experimenting with different chemicals on metal. Gujral's greatest fear is that his creativity will let him down. But going by this exhibition, it seems his fears are misplaced. At Lalit Kala Akademi studios, March 31 to April 7. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**



UNIQUE: Gujral (above) displays introspection in his new work



exhibition The Unspoken Word

MUMBAI When it comes to Shiladitya Sarkar, there is more to look and feel than there is to say—hence the rather apt title to his recent works of art, *Implicit Conversations*. "Multi talented, both as a writer and a painter, Shiladitya expresses himself eloquently equally in words and paintings," says Pravina Mecklai, curator of Jamaat. Painting in a distinctive style, Sarkar's works have layers upon layers of meaning that lend his paintings a rare perspective. He handles his works and colours with dexterity, blending textures with humour, irony and colours that seemingly "glow from within". Other concerns that become indispensable parts of Sarkar's repertoire are themes of duality, impermanence, alienation, a quest for self-identity and other socio-political issues. At Jamaat till April 25.

by Swati Mathur

MULTI-FACETED: Sarkar's paintings have humour and irony



dance Challenging Moves

DELHI In classical dance it is a challenge to depict philosophical or existential themes. Dancer Kumudini Lakhia addresses this desire for power and depicts what one does with it once it is harnessed. In *Atah Kim*, she restructures and discovers new movements in the dance form.



Lakhia (left) harnesses power
Presented by Shriram Bharatiya Kala Kendra, choreographed by Lakhia with music by Atul Desai. At Kamani Auditorium on March 31.